

DIGITAL MARKETING

UNIT I - Introduction to Digital Marketing: Overview of digital marketing, Evolution of digital marketing, Importance and benefits of digital marketing, Digital marketing channels and platforms

Digital Marketing Strategy and Planning: Developing a digital marketing strategy, Setting goals and objectives, Budgeting and resource allocation.

Introduction to Digital Marketing

OVERVIEW OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Digital marketing is the use of digital technologies and platforms to promote products and services, as well as to connect with potential customers. It is an incredibly versatile and powerful tool that can be used in various ways to reach people worldwide. Digital marketing utilizes multiple digital technologies to deliver promotional messages, such as mobile phones, computers, and other digital media and platforms. It can be used for B2B (Business to Business) and B2C (Business to Consumer) marketing, depending on the goal and objectives of the campaign. Digital marketing offers unique advantages such as greater reach, improved targeting, personalized messaging, and better ROI (Return on Investment). It also allows businesses to stay up-to-date with marketing trends and technologies. With the right strategies and tactics, companies can leverage digital marketing to increase their visibility and reach a larger audience.

What is Digital Marketing?

Digital marketing is the use of digital channels to market products. Also known as online marketing, digital marketing promotes brands and connects them to potential customers via the internet. It takes many forms, including:

- ✓ Search engines
- ✓ Websites
- ✓ Social media
- ✓ Email
- ✓ Mobile apps
- ✓ Text messaging
- ✓ Web-based advertising

- Digital marketing is a form of advertising that uses digital technology, such as the internet, mobile phones, and other digital media platforms to reach customers.
- The term digital marketing refers to the use of digital channels to market products and services to consumers. This type of marketing involves the use of websites, mobile devices, social media, search engines, and other similar channels.
- *Philip Kotler* is the father of digital marketing. Known for founding marketing as an academic discipline, he has written over 60 marketing books.

What are the 5Ds of Digital Marketing?

- **Digital Devices** – Digital devices are those that people use almost every day. Examples: laptops, desktops, smartphones, tablets, smart TVs, wearable devices, gaming devices.
- **Digital Platforms** – These are the platforms with which users interact regularly. You can use them for advertising. Examples: social media, search engines, websites.
- **Digital Media** – Paid or owned digital media channels can be used to reach your target audience. Examples: online ads, social media marketing, SMS, email marketing
- **Digital Data** – Data about your target audience used to achieve a marketing goal is called digital data. You can generally collect data about your target audience through surveys, apps, and other means. Examples: apps, contact forms, surveys
- **Digital Technology** – Digital technology is all about using technology to achieve a marketing goal. Examples: artificial intelligence, virtual reality, augmented reality

Traditional Marketing:

The traditional manner of marketing involved businesses to advertise their products or services on print media, radio and television commercials, business cards, bill boards, and in many other similar ways where Internet or social media websites were not employed for advertising. Traditional marketing policies had limited customer reachability and scope of driving customers’ buying behavior.

The following table lists a few points that differentiate digital marketing from traditional marketing –

Traditional Marketing	Digital Marketing
Communication is unidirectional. Means, a business communicates about its products or services with a group of people.	Communication is bidirectional. The customer also can ask queries or make suggestions about the business products and services.
Medium of communication is generally phone calls, letters, and Emails.	Medium of communication is mostly through social media websites, chat, and Email.
Campaigning takes more time for designing, preparing, and launching.	There is always a fast way to develop an online campaign and carry out changes along its development. With digital tools, campaigning is easier.
It is carried out for a specific audience throughout from generating campaign ideas up to selling a product or a service.	The content is available for general public. It is then made to reach the specific audience by employing search engine techniques.
It is conventional way of marketing; best for reaching local audience.	It is best for reaching global audience.
It is difficult to measure the effectiveness of a campaign.	It is easier to measure the effectiveness of a campaign through analytics.

EVOLUTION OF DIGITAL MARKETING

The term Digital Marketing was first used in the 1990s. The digital age took off with the coming of the internet and the development of the Web 1.0 platform. The Web 1.0 platform allowed users to find the information they wanted but did not allow them to share this information over the web. Up until then, marketers worldwide were still unsure of the digital platform.

- 1990: The term “Digital Marketing” was first used. In that particular year, ‘Archie” first search engine was launched.
- 1993: In this year first clickable web-ad banner was introduced.
- 1994: There was the launch of Yahoo and the first e-commerce transaction, over Net Market.
- 1996: In this year small search engines were introduced i.e. Hotbot, Looksmart, and Alexa.
- 1997: There was the launch of the first social media site which is SixDegree.com.
- 1998: This year was the changing year where there was the birth of Google, Microsoft launched MSN, and Yahoo! Introduced Yahoo! Web search.
- 2000: During this year Internet bubble burst, SixDegree.com shut down, and also smaller search engines were wiped out.
- 2001: This year’s first mobile marketing campaign was introduced i.e. Universal Music.
- 2002: This year is the birth year of LinkedIn.
- 2003: In this year WordPress was introduced and launched MySpace
- 2004: This year was changing year when Gmail was launched, Google goes public and Facebook goes live.
- 2005: Youtube was introduced in this particular year.

- 2006: Microsoft launches MS Live Search. In this year Twitter was launched, moreover Amazon's e-commerce sales crossed \$10 billion.
- 2007: Tumblr, Web streaming service: Hulu, and iPhone were launched.
- 2008: This year China take over America in terms of the number of users and even Spotify was introduced to listen to online songs
- 2009: Google launches Instant for real-time search engine results. In this year Whatsapp was introduced to make communication easier.
- 2010: Pinterest and Instagram were launched.
- 2011: In this year Google Buzz shut down and also web overtake the TV viewership among the youth generation.
- 2012: There was a progressive increment in Social Media Budget that is up to 64%.
- 2013: Yahoo acquired Tumblr in this particular year.
- 2014: In this year so many things happened like Mobile exceeds PC internet usage.
- 2015: In this era, Snapchat was launched and also there was the rise of predictive analytics.
- 2016 – Yahoo discontinued some of its services
- 2017– TikTok was launched
- 2019– Google+ left the market
- 2021 – 99% of digital marketers use social media sites for marketing purposes
- 2023 – AI Chatbots like ChatGPT have taken over the internet.

IMPORTANCE AND BENEFITS OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Why is digital marketing important?

Importance:

- Digital marketing is an important component of any successful business strategy. It allows companies to reach a wider audience and create a personalized connection with customers. It also provides businesses with an opportunity to engage with customers on a more personal level, creating a sense of trust and loyalty. Additionally, digital marketing gives businesses access to real-time analytics, enabling them to make informed decisions and track the success of their campaigns.
- Any type of marketing can help your business thrive. However, digital marketing has become increasingly important because of how accessible digital channels are. In fact, there were 5 billion internet users globally in April 2022 alone.
- From social media to text messages, there are many ways to use digital marketing tactics in order to communicate with your target audience. Additionally, digital marketing has minimal upfront costs, making it a cost-effective marketing technique for small businesses.

BENEFITS / ADVANTAGES:

Benefits of Digital Marketing are:

1. Global reach
2. Cost efficiency
3. Measurable results
4. Effective targeting
5. Increased engagement
6. Flexibility
7. Improved conversion rate
8. Social currency
9. Greater ROI
10. Brand Awareness

1. Global reach

Traditional marketing strategies like billboards, TV ads, and cold sales calls are limited by geography. But with digital marketing, businesses can access a global audience across locations and time zones. Instead of limiting your reach to people in your community, you can target potential customers in your state, country, and even globally.

2. Cost efficiency

The next advantage of digital marketing is its low cost. Whether you want to advertise your company locally or globally, digital marketing offers cost-effective alternatives. It enables even the tiniest businesses to compete with larger corporations by employing highly targeted techniques. Most of these methods (such as SEO, social media, and content marketing) will be free to begin with.

3. Measurable results

Not only is digital marketing more affordable than offline marketing tactics — it's also highly measurable. With digital marketing, you can track nearly every touchpoint users have with your brand. Whether it's social media views, ad clicks, email opens, or organic page views, every aspect of digital marketing is highly trackable. It's much easier to prove the return on investment (ROI) of your digital marketing efforts as a result, which helps you better understand the results you're generating and where to keep investing.

4. Effective targeting

Digital marketing allows you to pinpoint the best audience for your messages using online audience and targeting information. You can also collect data from your digital campaigns to see which content works best for certain types of customers. If you're still learning about your customers' preferences, these insights can help you refine your campaigns over time.

5. Increased engagement

Increased engagement is one of the most essential benefits of digital marketing. By default, digital marketing is intended to be very engaging. Users can share a blog post, like a photo, bookmark a video, or interact with your website by clicking on a sponsored ad. What's important is that all of these actions are trackable. This allows you to generate even more interesting posts in order to improve brand awareness or sales. The more you engage with clients online, the more loyal they will become. Businesses that effectively use engaging formats in their online initiatives have a better chance of converting cold traffic to loyal consumers.

6. Flexibility

Digital marketing gives you the flexibility to choose from different channels and strategies. It's also flexible enough that you can adjust your approach over time as you learn more about what works for your audience and business. There are several types of digital marketing strategies to choose from, including: Search engine marketing, Social paid ads, Video marketing, Forum engagement, Social media marketing, Email marketing, Local search, Influencer marketing, etc.

7. Improved conversion rate

When a customer converts, they take a desired action. That might be subscribing to your email newsletter or making a purchase. Your conversion rate measures the percentage of customers who take that desired action. Generally speaking, the higher your conversion rates, the more successful your marketing efforts.

8. Social currency

Social currency is what happens when content passes from user to user, eventually becoming viral and making a name for your brand. In the past, social currency happened largely through word-of-mouth recommendations. Today, thanks to the power of digital strategies like social media marketing, your business can build social currency by creating content that's highly relevant, entertaining, and timely. Social currency keeps the conversation going long after your brand's posts go live and can keep your business top of mind with consumers.

9. Greater ROI (Returns on Investment)

Digital marketing gives businesses more value for their investment — and it's easier to prove ROI because you can easily attribute sales and conversions to specific campaigns and touchpoints. In an age where marketers increasingly need to do more with fewer resources, digital channels empower businesses to market themselves in the most cost-effective way.

10. Brand Awareness

Digital marketing can help businesses build brand awareness and recognition. This is important for businesses that want to attract new customers and grow their business. With digital marketing, your company can establish brand credibility across a larger market.

DIGITAL MARKETING CHANNELS AND PLATFORMS

Digital marketing channels are platforms you can use to reach your target audiences online. They might include social media, search engines or websites. Digital marketing channels give you the opportunity to sell products, build brand awareness and position yourself within a given industry.

A digital marketing platform is a solution that supports a variety of functions within the realm of marketing over the internet.

Here are some of the most effective marketing channels for businesses:

1. Social Media Marketing
2. Search Engine Optimization (SEO)
3. Email Marketing
4. Video Marketing
5. Pay-per-click (PPC)
6. Affiliate Marketing
7. Influencer Marketing
8. Content Marketing
9. Mobile marketing
10. Referral marketing

- **Social Media Marketing:**

Social media marketing is one of the most important digital marketing channels. It's the process of promoting your brand, products, or services on social media platforms like Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, Twitter, and LinkedIn.

Social media marketing can be used in a digital marketing campaign to connect with your target audience, build a community around your brand, and drive website traffic.

This Channel is for: Ecommerce brands, retailers, creative agencies, freelancers, and many other businesses that deal with the public see enormous benefits from an investment in social media.

Benefits of Social Media as a Marketing Channel:

1. Make your brand more relatable
2. Robust, built-in analytics so you can track and meet your social media KPIs
3. Free to use in almost all cases

- **Search Engine Optimization (SEO):**

Search engine optimization (SEO) is the process of improving the ranking of a website on search engines. The higher the ranking, the more likely people are to find the website, and the higher your website traffic numbers from organic search.

Search Engine Optimization, is about making your website page rank higher on internet search engines like Google, Bing, etc.

Search engine optimization (SEO) describes a variety of techniques that companies use in an effort to increase traffic to their website and raise its position in search results. The higher a site appears on the search results page, the more likely consumers are to see it and potentially click to visit it.

This channel is for any business with a website can benefit from SEO because ranking well in search engines exposes your business to potentially hundreds of thousands or even millions of people who use search engines every day.

Benefits of SEO as a Marketing Channel:

1. Helps users find your business organically, increasing trust
2. Provides compounding returns over time as you gain more rankings
3. Allows you to target every stage of the sales funnel with different keywords
4. Building a social media persona helps customers connect with your brand

To win at organic search, you need to understand many complex concepts, including keyword research, backlinks, and how Google's algorithms treat page experience and trust signals.

SEO is closely linked with content marketing. If you consistently create high-quality content around relevant topics, it will help improve search visibility, which can increase website traffic.

- **Email Marketing:**

Email marketing is a direct marketing channel where you send marketing materials to subscribers' email addresses.

Email offers a much more personal way of connecting with your targeted customers. It is a type of internet marketing that can truly make you stand out. You can offer exclusive 'insider' content, special discounts, and customized content to your email subscribers to make them feel special. The attractive bargains may also prompt non-subscribers to sign up for updates.

Benefits of Email Marketing:

1. Provides a direct way to reach someone — all you need is an email address to reach the top of their inbox
2. Can yield fast results (More than half of recipients who opened marketing emails opened them within six hours of receiving them)
3. Can be automated with low-cost or even free software

This Channel is for: If you publish content on your website's blog, offer periodic sales or giveaways, or want to promote a new product offering, then email marketing may be an effective online marketing channel for you.

The first step of email marketing is to build an email list. Once you have some email addresses, send regular emails to nurture them. You might choose to send an email newsletter or simply send out emails each time you are running a sale or when you publish a new blog post.

- **Video Marketing:**

Video marketing is using videos to promote your business and product/services.

With people watching an average of 19 hours of video per week, video marketing is an opportunity most businesses can't pass up.

And video marketing is a goldmine for capturing attention and turning interest into sales.

Benefits of Video Marketing:

1. More leads (Around 86% of people who do video marketing say this channel is effective at generating leads for their business)
2. Can be an engaging medium for many users
3. Much more likely than many other types of content to result in purchases on social media

This Channel Is For: Anyone who has a smartphone can record a shareable video to market products or services. However, to create branded videos that represent the image you want to project, you may need a small video marketing budget to invest in video editing software or a video production service.

Video advertising is one of the most entertaining and interactive **online marketing channels**. It includes online display ads that have a video within them. Such ads are also played before, during, or after a video stream.

To capitalize on this massive opportunity, there are a variety of video marketing formats for you to choose from, including: Demos, Product launches, Event videos, Educational and how-to videos, Brand videos, Webinars, Live videos, Case studies, Customer testimonials, Expert interviews, Documentary-style videos, Personalized messages.

- **Pay-per-click (PPC) or Search Engine Marketing (SEM):**

Pay-per-click (PPC) advertising enables marketers to reach audiences on news and other websites and digital platforms through paid ads. Marketers can set up PPC campaigns on Google, Bing, LinkedIn, X (formerly Twitter), Pinterest, and Facebook and show their ads to people searching terms related to their products or services.

Pay-per-click advertising, or PPC advertising, is the process of buying visibility on **search engine results pages (SERPs)**. Search engine marketing, or SEM, refers to paid advertisements that appear at the top of the SERP. The cost of these ads typically depends on the number of clicks the link receives, hence “pay-per-click.”

When you pay for these top SERP slots, the “Ad” label will appear next to your URL. Despite consumer knowledge that these are ads, many still click on these links, and it can be a very effective digital marketing strategy.

Paid advertising is an online advertising model where you pay to place ads on different platforms. If you want to grow quickly, ads can help.

Benefits of PPC Advertising:

1. Can provide nearly immediate sales
2. Doesn't require you to fight to rank for competitive keywords
3. Only pay for the clicks your ads get

This Channel Is For: PPC isn't for everyone. But for those who have a fairly sizable marketing budget, it can be an ideal way to generate quick leads, which hopefully lead to conversions.

Paid search, also known as pay-per-click (PPC), is a form of online advertising that allows businesses to have their ads displayed when someone searches for a particular keyword or product, but only pay when someone takes action on an ad. Because of its flexibility and ability to reach users that have a clear intent, PPC advertising is often seen as one of the most important digital marketing channels.

- **Affiliate Marketing:**

Affiliate marketing is a commission-based sales scheme that rewards web publishers when they sell one of your business' products through their website, social media profile, or another digital platform.

Online sellers can get other dealers to sell their products and services. This is called affiliate marketing, wherein one business offers another's products as an add-on or deal package along with its own. The guidelines and prerequisites may be different for every seller. Affiliate marketing is quite similar to a commissioned sales job.

Affiliate marketing is a process by which businesses encourage other websites to promote their products or services in exchange for a commission on any sales generated. It can be a simple but effective way

to increase your reach and drive more traffic to your website.

Affiliate networks act as the 'middle-men' between advertisers and publishers, helping ensure everything is tracked and the right commission is paid. Affiliate marketing is an effective way to expand your reach by getting in front of others' audiences.

Benefits of Affiliate Marketing:

1. Only pay when your affiliate marketing efforts result in a sale
2. Can increase brand awareness for your business.
3. Builds a degree of trust that is hard to recreate through cold sales and marketing

This Channel is for: Affiliate marketing is ideal for eCommerce businesses selling physical products, but it can also work well for digital products like courses and downloadable content.

- **Influencer Marketing:**

Influencer marketing is when a brand builds awareness and trust for a product among an influencer's followers (or fans) by using the influencer's power.

Influencer marketing is a type of social media marketing that uses endorsements and product mentions from influencers — individuals who have a dedicated social following and are viewed as experts within their position / role.

Benefits of Influencer Marketing:

1. Increases brand awareness
2. Enrich content strategy
3. Creates trust in your brand in unique audiences
4. Increase sales
5. Cost-effective and saves time
6. Allows granular audience targeting
7. Can lead to long-term partnerships with influencers
8. Suitable for any business

This Channel is for: Influencer marketing is most effective when you have identified the audiences you would most like to reach online. Otherwise, you may end up with a scattershot approach that doesn't reach your target customer.

- **Content Marketing:**

Content marketing is the strategic planning, creation, publication, and distribution of valuable content to your target audience. Unlike ads, which interrupt the individual in order to try to sell something, content marketing delivers VALUE throughout the customer journey.

Content marketing is the creation and distribution of content (like blogs, videos, or social media posts) to attract and retain customers.

It is often less promotional and more educational than other digital marketing campaigns. Some of the most common types of content marketing assets include: Blog posts, White papers, E-books, Case studies, Infographics

Content marketing refers to informational, valuable content like blog posts, how-to videos, and other instructional materials. This type of marketing helps you connect with your audience and answer their questions. It can also help to generate leads and close sales.

Content should be published regularly with the target audience in mind. Ideally, your brand would become a trusted voice within the industry by publishing quality, reliable content. You want your audience to come to you first for information on the latest industry trends.

Benefits of Content Marketing:

1. It's free of cost.
2. Content is a highly versatile option. It allows you to build your brand by educating, entertaining and inspiring the audience.
3. It fuels all the other types of digital marketing.

- **Mobile Marketing:**

Mobile marketing is any advertising activity that promotes products and services via mobile devices, such as tablets and smartphones. It makes use of features of modern mobile technology, including location services, to tailor marketing campaigns based on an individual's location.

Mobile marketing is a way in which technology can be used to create personalized promotion of goods or services to a user who is constantly connected to a network.

Mobile marketing tools are digital marketing strategies that companies use to reach their target audience through a variety of channels that are available on smartphones, tablets, and other digital devices. These can include ads placed on social media, such as Twitter and Instagram, or pop-up ads on browsers.

Some free mobile marketing tools include AppsFlyer, Insider, Branch, and CleverTap.

The top mobile marketing apps include Facebook Pages, WhatsApp Business, YouTube Studio, Instagram Business, and Twitter for Business.

Benefits of Mobile Marketing:

1. Mobile marketing is much easier to access. You don't need high-level technology or significant technical experience to get started.
2. Mobile marketing is also extremely cost-effective. There are a variety of options to choose from for any budget and the impact it can have when compared to the cost is significant.
3. Customers can also be reached in real-time with mobile marketing no matter where they are.

Therefore Mobile marketing is an affordable way to reach your target audience via smartphones, tablets, or other digital devices, where people spend the majority of their time in today's world. Mobile marketing is low-cost and can be targeted based on a variety of inputs from the company.

- **Referral marketing:**

Referral marketing is a highly valuable digital marketing channel. People listen to their friends, family, and online peers.

Referral marketing uses customer recommendations and word-of-mouth to earn new customers. Happy customers are your brand's biggest asset because people trust their friends' and family's opinions more than anything else. Humans are social creatures. We intuitively tell people about good experiences so they can enjoy them too. Similarly, if we've had a bad experience, we share it so others can avoid the pain and frustration.

Referral marketing encourages people to promote your business by rewarding them for spreading the good word.

Referral marketing often comes in the form of **online reviews**, comments on product listings, and social media discussions.

An effective way to engage in referral marketing is to ask for referrals! You can start gathering these referrals using a number of customer marketing or referral apps that help you build an army of advocates.

DIGITAL MARKETING PLATFORMS

A digital marketing platform is a tool that links marketers and consumers and it builds awareness, engagement and community.

There are several different types of platforms, including social media platforms, service platforms, and media sharing platforms.

Why are digital marketing platforms important?

- ✓ Guiding the buyer's journey
- ✓ Allowing for growth and scalability
- ✓ Attracting technology users
- ✓ Creating technological leverage

DIGITAL MARKETING STRATEGY AND PLANNING

What is Digital Marketing Strategy?

A digital marketing strategy is a comprehensive plan that outlines how a business will achieve its marketing goals via online channels like search, social media, and email. It involves understanding your target audience, setting clear objectives, and implementing effective digital marketing tactics to reach and engage your audience.

DEVELOPING / CREATING A DIGITAL MARKETING STRATEGY

These are the steps to follow to create an effective marketing strategy:

1. Identify Target Audience And Build Personas
2. Set goals and objectives
3. Evaluate your existing digital marketing presence
4. Build your Content Strategy
5. Set key performance indicators and benchmarks
6. Identify Budget Constraints
7. Execute and Optimize digital marketing strategy
8. Analyze Results

Identify Target Audience And Build Personas

A digital marketing strategy will only be as good as the target audience behind it. After all, they're the ones who purchase your brand's products and services.

When identifying a target persona, consider the following items:

- **Demographics:** After identifying where to sell your products/services, determine if any key geographic areas may outperform others. Other demographic categories are age, parental status, household income, and more.
- **Interests:** What kinds of hobbies does your ideal persona have? This information can help shape content for the customer.
- **Behaviors:** How (and where) do these users consume content on the internet? Are they impulse shoppers? What social platforms do they frequent?
- **Pain points:** What problems are users trying to solve? This is the key area to focus on. By providing your target audience with a solution to their pain points and speaking to them in a way they understand, you'll likely win a customer for life.

Set Goals and Objectives

Defining precise and measurable goals is the foundation of any effective digital marketing strategy.

Before you decide on a digital marketing strategy, establish and document your short- and long-term goals. After you decide on your strategy, outline and document specific objectives so you'll know if your strategy is working. Make sure your goals and objectives are SMART (specific, measurable, attainable, relevant, and timely).

- **Goal.** Increase awareness of our widgets among our target audience.
- **Strategy (how you'll achieve the goal).** Use content marketing to persuade buyers that our widgets are the best in the market by creating content for at least two user personas in every step of the sales funnel.
- **Objective (how you'll know if the strategy is working).** Achieve a 25% increase of downloads of our widget whitepapers and eBooks each quarter and boost email subscribers by 50% in 6 months.

Document all your goals, strategies, and objectives so that you can refer to them when it's time to measure success.

Evaluate your existing digital marketing presence

Even if it's close to nonexistent, it's good to understand what you have already accomplished. This step will help you understand what to focus on to achieve your current goals.

First, you need to understand your main marketing channels:

- Your website
- Social media
- Email marketing
- Content marketing/SEO
- Pay per click advertising

Which of these is driving the most leads and traffic to you? Rank each channel and specific media from most effective to least effective.

Build your Content Strategy

Based on your marketing objectives and your target audience, map out a content plan. This should identify the main topics or buckets of content to include in your execution.

Here are five ways to get content inspiration:

- Look for ideas from your competition and customer analysis.
- Check out Answer the Public to see the questions that people are asking in search engines.
- Search hashtags on Instagram to see what is trending. Instagram is highly visual, so it is a great source of inspirational content.
- Look at Google Search suggestions. This shows what people are searching for related to your category.
- Explore Pinterest, which is full of viral, visual, highly shared content.

Set key performance indicators (KPI) and benchmarks

Each activity that you invest in should have a clear KPI, which is your measure of success.

Any digital marketing strategy should be measured continuously. Identify key performance indicators or KPIs, which are measurable values that gauge the effectiveness of your strategy and tactics. Some examples of KPIs include:

- Digital conversion rates
- Cost per lead
- Returning website visitors
- Click through rates
- Customer lifetime values.

Once your digital marketing campaign concludes you can hold a wash-up meeting with all relevant parties to share data around its successes and failures, which can feed into future digital marketing strategy planning.

Next, set benchmarks. Your benchmark is what you want to achieve. For example, with email marketing, my KPI could be my email open rate, and my benchmark could be reaching 25% or better.

Identify Budget Constraints

Fundamentally, commercial and nonprofit organizations of every flavor must ensure that they budget appropriately to roll out an effective digital marketing strategy. Even the best marketing strategies and tactics are dependent upon adequate cash flow. Consequently, it is vital for organizations to think realistically about their budget to determine which marketing tactics are achievable and affordable.

Execute and Optimize digital marketing strategy

Once you've defined above steps, it's time to launch your digital marketing strategy.

However, the work is not done yet. Your digital marketing strategy should be ongoing and fluid based on performance and the changing market landscape.

Digital marketing channels and campaigns should be continuously monitored and analyzed to ensure that marketing budgets and resources are utilized most effectively.

This should include daily, weekly, and monthly checkpoints in each channel.

Monthly reports and quarterly business reviews (QBRs) should be conducted to provide opportunities to shift and pivot strategy based on findings.

Analyze Results

The work doesn't stop after you've designed and implemented your digital marketing strategy. The next step is one of the most important: **analysing the results**. Analytics has turned into a critical pillar for successfully optimizing digital marketing performance and spending.

We have to measure every action using KPIs to **figure out if we earned the expected ROI**. Measuring the effectiveness of the strategies and activities we have implemented in our digital marketing strategy will help us correct what doesn't work to achieve the goals we set.

SETTING GOALS AND OBJECTIVES

Digital marketing goals and objectives are essentially the metrics that you will use to measure the success of your campaigns. They can include one or more of the following:

- Generate more leads
- Improve your conversion rate
- Increase your sales
- Boost your traffic

How to set digital marketing goals and objectives?

It is worth noting that the digital marketing goals and objectives mentioned above should only act as broader aims. It is also important that your teams set SMART marketing goals. That is to say that all digital marketing goals and objectives should be:

- **Specific:** What are the audiences or personas that we are targeting to gain these new leads? Which channels will we use to reach them?
- **Measurable:** How many leads should we aim to get in total from the campaign? What will be the exact KPIs that we track for this campaign or set of campaigns?

- **Attainable:** What is the percentage we will need to increase our leads by and is that realistic to achieve? What has been our performance over previous quarters?
- **Relevant:** How can we appeal to the pain points of this audience and how does our product or service seek to solve them? Can we offer them very specific benefits?
- **Time-bound:** How long will this campaign run for? When would we like to measure how successful our digital marketing goals and objectives have been?

BUDGETING AND RESOURCE ALLOCATION

What is a digital marketing Budget?

It is a set amount of funds that the company uses only for its digital marketing activities. Essentially, budgets comprise media costs, creative production, agency fees, and digital tools and technology for the purpose of delivering on a campaign or strategy. Additionally, staff costs, training and processes can be included as part of the overall budget.

Marketers might use the affordable, percentage-of-sales, marginal analysis, competitive parity, and objective-task methods to construct a marketing budget. A marketing budget is an outline of the costs that a company will spend to market its product or service.

The budget allocation varies based on industry, company objectives, and maturity. Typically, around 40-50% goes to digital marketing, 20-30% to traditional marketing, 10-20% to events and sponsorships, and 5-10% to research and analytics.

We've listed a few reasons as to why a digital marketing budget is important for your business or company-

- Provides a clear sense of direction. It makes the management believe in your efforts as well as you can share the results later
- There is clarity on the allocation of financial funds
- Easier coordination and planning of other areas of the company such as finance, human resources, etc.
- It provides a foundation for comparing actual results. This can give you a clear picture of how much you earned from investing in a particular area of digital marketing.
- You will have a better idea of which marketing avenues to choose whilst looking at your allocated budget. This can maximize your ROI and also prevent wasteful spending.
- A budget also makes the team more responsible with their marketing spending as they are answerable to the management.

Resource Allocation

Resource planning refers to businesses' strategic decision-making process to allocate resources, assign them to specific tasks, and optimize their performance.

The term "resource" includes human, financial, and technological resources needed to develop and execute a successful digital marketing strategy.

Importance of Resource Allocation:

- Resource allocation is essential in digital marketing because it ensures businesses achieve their goals while minimizing costs.
- When resources are spread out poorly or allocated inadequately, it can lead to wastage, and the digital marketing strategy may need to be more effective than intended.
- Therefore, businesses that want to achieve their marketing objectives and generate high ROI must have a well-defined resource plan.

Resource allocation is the art of continuously evaluating existing resources and distributing them across various projects, based on project priority, the time needed to complete, amount of work to be done, etc. taking into consideration the buffer time for any emergency situations (company or personal).